Healthy Eating: Educational Reference Notes

A balanced diet provides a variety of foods and nutrients in appropriate amounts. A varied eating pattern can include vegetables, fruits, pulses, whole grains, nuts, and suitable protein sources. Fruits and vegetables provide fibre, vitamins, minerals, and other useful compounds. Whole grains retain more of the grain's natural structure than refined grains and can contribute dietary fibre. Choosing water instead of sugary drinks and limiting foods high in free sugars can help reduce excess sugar intake. Salt, saturated fat, and highly processed foods are also worth considering as part of an overall eating pattern. Healthy eating is about the pattern over time rather than one meal. Food choices should account for culture, availability, allergies, medical needs, and personal circumstances.